

Lex'it

HowTo

IvdNT

Mathieu Fannee, 2019 – 2022

Inhoud

Introduction.....	7
What is Lex'it?	7
API	7
Installation: quick start.....	8
Prerequisites.....	8
Build the project	8
Copy needed files to the server.....	10
Set your user.....	11
First test.....	12
My first project.....	13
The .database file	13
The .config.js file.....	13
Remarks.....	15
Full list of configuration parameters	17
oTableSettingsList parameters	17
oTableConfigurationList parameters.....	20
Assign rights to users.....	25
Setting rights	25
Activating rights.....	25
The API.....	26
First things first: open a table.....	26
Close a table	27
Project wide settings	28
Setting a project title	28
Table global settings.....	29
General settings.....	29
Is a table loaded?.....	29
View type	29
Row selection	29
Is a table empty?	29
Table results count quality	29
Positioning.....	30
Table absolute positioning	30
Table relative positioning	30
Saving and retrieving settings	30

Read the configuration settings	30
Restore the configuration settings	30
Save table extra settings (position etc.) for later re-use	31
Save and restore table state.....	31
Tabel header.....	32
Ways of setting header buttons	32
Add a SELECT button	32
Implement a button for row duplication	33
Click on a button programmatically	33
Modify the name/style of a button programmatically	33
Filters & search boxes in the GUI	35
Modify a user's search query programmatically, before search is fired.....	35
Modifying the filter silently (that is: without modifying the search boxes).....	36
Query builder.....	36
Tabel-body.....	38
Dealing with rows.....	38
Which row is now selected?.....	38
Iterating over rows	38
Get total number of rows.....	38
Get all visible rows.....	38
Get all visible rows meeting some filters	39
Select or unselect row programmatically.....	39
Dealing with cells.....	39
Get a cell and its type, given a row node and a column name	39
Assign a mouse event to a cell	39
Assign a mouse event to an element in a cell	40
Highlighting data in cells.....	40
Sorting data	41
Read data.....	41
Read text from cells, columns, of rows	41
Read selected text in cell.....	42
Read id's of rows	43
Write data.....	43
Write data in editable cells.....	43
Sending data to the database.....	44
Context menus in cells or rows	44

Refreshing a table, or only single rows	45
Remove data.....	45
Remove a row.....	45
Implement an autocomplete in an editable cell	46
Wild cards in columns configuration.....	47
Callbacks.....	48
Table callbacks.....	48
Function callbacks	49
Updating a table configuration after initialization.....	50
Error handlers.....	51
Table columns error handlers	51
Function error handlers.....	51
Dialogs	52
Classic dialogs.....	52
Entering data in a dialog.....	52
Data to be typed in.....	52
Data to be chosen out of a list of items	53
Data to be sorted.....	54
Menu dialog.....	54
Get rid of the 'OK' button.....	55
Closing a dialog programmatically	55
Show a progress indicator and hide it.....	55
Key events	56
Assign even to some key	56
Trigger a key event programmatically.....	56
Detect which key was stricken.....	57
Calling external resources:	58
Call a database function and get its output	58
Call a webservice	58
Advanced Lex'it programming	60
Lex'it internal registry.....	60
Create a full new table configuration at runtime.....	60
Set the active table programmatically	61
Use libraries.....	61
Accessing session and user info	62
Cleaning the cache	63

Setting behavior when switching between tabs containing distinct Lex'it instances	64
Changing accessed table schema	64
Tips and tricks.....	65
Call a Lex'it projects and tables via an URL	65
Change table columns visibility and redraw table automatically	65
Synchronicity problems and solutions	65
Implement a character picker	66
Scroll to a table programmatically	67
Help functions	68
String array conversion.....	68
Escaping chars	68
Http parameters	68
Solve z-Index problems	68
Objects functions.....	68
Clone an object.....	68
Count the number of properties of an object	69
Regex functions	69
Test if a string is a regex or not	69
Regex version of replaceAll(string, replacement)	69
Regex version of indexOf(regex, from) and lastIndexOf(regex, from)	69
Regex version of inArray(value, array, start).....	69
Regex selectors.....	69
Arrays functions.....	69
Unify any value in array.....	69
Clone an array	69
Array equality	70
Sort an array of arrays	70
HTML entities	70
Numbers	70
Generate series (JavaScript version of Psql function)	70
Get a random unique number.....	70
String functions	71
The good old BASIC or JAVA functions	71
String replacement.....	71
Remove HTML tags from a string	71
Remove non alphabetical chars from string	71

If a string a string?	71
If a string truly empty?	71
Colors.....	71
Is a color dark or light?	71
Convert a string to a color	71
Text selection	72
Allow or prevent screen text selection.....	72
Clear screen text selection	72
DOM elements functions	72
Test if some element is visible in the current viewport	72
Does an element exist?	72
Events	72
Pre-binding	72
PSQL functions in Lex'it	73
Call a PSQL-function and read the result.....	73
Concordance table for the fn and fx namespaces.....	74

Introduction

What is Lex'it?

In short: a customizable web interface on databases. Out of the box, it allows for viewing or editing database tables within a webpage, and offers searching, paging and sorting functionalities without any configuration needed.

Thanks to an extensive API, developers can easily customize or extend the standard functionalities. And programming is not limited to the Lex'it API: since it all runs with JavaScript and jQuery, lots of third parties js-plugins can be implemented in Lex'it projects.

API

The client-side part of Lex'it is built with the datatables.net framework, so as a consequence the Lex'it API uses the same objects as datatables.

Since its creation, the datatables API (<https://datatables.net/reference/api/>) has gone through a lot of development, causing its API to shift from one type of objects to another. Originally addressing the DOM tree and its nodes, datatables now works with its own table representation object. The Lex'it API still uses both approaches: the first one is represented by the `fn` namespace (mostly addressing nodes) and the other by the `fx` namespace (mostly addressing datatables objects). The Lex'it API provides of course a set of functions allowing both functions types to be used together.

The Lex'it API is described at github.com/INL/Lexit/tree/master/jsdoc, so we won't be doing that again here. But do consult the **Concordance table for the fn and fx namespaces** in this document!

The aim of this document is to give clear examples of how to use some functions. This tries to give an answer to the question: how can I get Lex'it to do this for me?

Installation: quick start

Prerequisites

- A server running Java 7+ and Apache tomcat 8.5+ which is needed to host the Lex'it webservice
- A server (might be the same as the first one) running PostgreSQL 10+ containing the database to be viewed or edited in Lex'it

Build the project

Lex'it is stored in GitHub : <https://github.com/INL/Lexit>

Clone it and build it:

```
git clone https://github.com/INL/Lexit
cd Lexit
mvn package
```

Prior to Java 11 this should be enough. In newer Java version, you'll get error "*package javax.xml.bind does not exist*". So solve this, just add the following lines to the POM.xml (and rerun `mvn package`):

```
<dependency>
  <groupId>javax.xml.bind</groupId>
  <artifactId>jaxb-api</artifactId>
  <version>2.4.0-b180830.0359</version>
</dependency>
<dependency>
  <groupId>com.sun.xml.bind</groupId>
  <artifactId>jaxb-core</artifactId>
  <version>2.3.0.1</version>
</dependency>
<dependency>
  <groupId>com.sun.xml.bind</groupId>
  <artifactId>jaxb-impl</artifactId>
  <version>2.4.0-b180830.0438</version>
</dependency>
<dependency>
  <groupId>javax.annotation</groupId>
  <artifactId>javax.annotation-api</artifactId>
  <version>1.3.2</version>
</dependency>
```

It might also be needed to set the compiler plugin to an higher version in the POM.xml (and rerun `mvn package`):

```
<!-- Compiles Java sources -->
<plugin>
  <groupId>org.apache.maven.plugins</groupId>
  <artifactId>maven-compiler-plugin</artifactId>
  <version>3.8.0</version>
  <configuration>
    <release>8</release>
    <encoding>UTF-8</encoding>
  </configuration>
</plugin>
```


Lex'it HowTo

```
<plugin>
  <groupId>org.apache.maven.plugins</groupId>
  <artifactId>maven-war-plugin</artifactId>
  <version>3.3.0</version>
</plugin>
```

Now you've got a WAR-file (`lexit2.war`) to be installed on the tomcat server.

Copy needed files to the server

We need some files to be copied to the tomcat server, that is:

- lexit2.war (the WAR file you just built)
- the /lexit2/lexit2_config_folders folder (projects configuration folders)

Send those to the tomcat server:

```
scp lexit2.war root@<your_host>:<some_folder>
scp -r /lexit2 config_folders root@<your_host>:<some_folder>
```

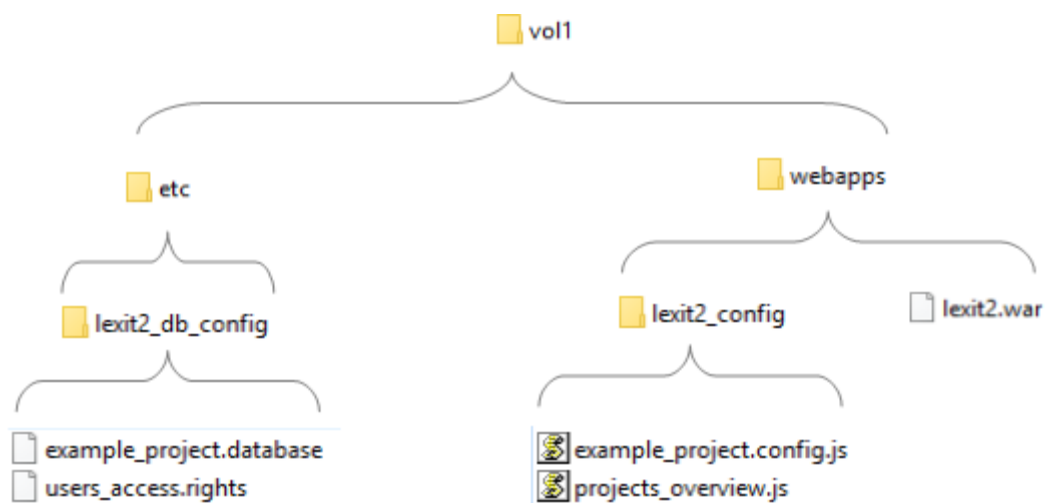
The 'lexit2_config_folders' folder contains two subfolders:

- /webapps/lexit2_config
This folder is about projects functionalities. It is supposed to contains Javascript files only!
- /etc/lexit2_db_config
This folder contains the projects' databases credentials and the users access rights settings.

Now go to the tomcat server, copy the war file and the lexit2_config folder to the tomcat webapps folder (eg. /vol1/webapps), and copy the lexit2_db_config folder to the parent of the webapps folder (eg. /vol1).

```
ssh root@<your_host>
mv lexit2.war /vol1/webapps
mv lexit2_config_folders/webapps/lexit2_config/ /vol1/webapps/
mv lexit2_config_folders/etc /vol1
```

You should end up with the following structure:



NB: In the older Lex'it versions, all config files were stored in the `/webapps/lexit2_config` folder, but it turned out to be a bad idea. Since the `webapps` folder can be accessed by the client, it can form a security risk [remember: it contains the database credentials]. That's why we eventually chose for a new location, which can't be accessed by the client.

Set your user

Finally, you need to declare a tomcat user and assign him/her Lex'it access rights, so as to be able to log in.

First go to the `/vol1/etc/lexit2_db_config` folder, open file `users_access.rights` and add your username followed by `'=superuser'` (for sake of ease, we now assign full rights – later on we'll read more about this in section **Assign rights to users**):

```
myname=superuser
```

As a second step, go to the tomcat config folder and open the tomcat users file:

```
cd /etc/tomcat
sudo vi tomcat-users.xml
```

Add a Lex'it access 'role', which we will be assigning to any user needing to work with Lex'it. Of course, we'll need to restart tomcat afterwards, in such a way that it takes the new role and users into account:

```
<role rolename="lexit_access"/>
<user username="myname" password="12345" roles="lexit_access"/>

:qw!

sudo service tomcat restart
```

First test

As far as files installation on the server is concerned, we're done now. You can test your installation by typing the Lex'it URL in a genuine browser.¹

```
http://<your_host>:8080/lexit2/
```

You should be getting a start screen like the following. The screen displays some project names you might want to try. Of course, clicking those links won't work properly, because those are dummy's for the sake of being able to test the front page of your installation. We now need to build a project and configure it! We'll do that in the next section.

Welkom in Lex'it

Kies een project:

Productie

◆	Some beautiful project name	: <i>This project is about beautiful things</i>
◆	Another wonderful project name	: <i>This project is wonderful too</i>

Goodies en tools

	Login overzicht	: <i>Overzicht actieve accounts (wordt om de 2 sec bijgewerkt)</i>
	Reset user rights	: <i>Toegangsrechten resetten (klik alleen als het nodig is, geen speelgoed!)</i>

In ontwikkeling

◆	Yet another project	: <i>This project is being tested</i>
---	-------------------------------------	---------------------------------------

Afgesloten

◆	Some project of the past	: <i>We used to work on this one, we're finished with it now</i>
---	--	--

Onbekend

◆	example_project	: <i>onbekend</i>
---	---------------------------------	-------------------

¹ Lex'it was successfully tested in browsers Chrome, Mozilla Firefox and Edge. Internet Explorer is not a browser (nobody knows what that is).

My first project

A project needs only two files:

- a `.database` file, which contains the project database location and credentials
- a `.config.js` file, which indicates which database tables can be accessed, how they should look and behave, etc.

These two files need to be named the following way: if your project is named 'myproject', those two files should be called `myproject.database` and `myproject.config.js`

As for their storage location:

- The `myproject.config.js` file must be stored in the tomcat webapps folder in 'configuration' subfolder `/webapps/lexit2_config`.
- The `myproject.database` file can't be saved in the same location, because the webapps folder can be accessed by the client so it can form a security risk (since it contains the database credentials). So we need to store the file elsewhere: `/etc/lexit2_db_config`. We saw before that the `etc` folder was created next to (that is: as a sibling of) the `webapps` folder.

The `.database` file

A typical `.database` file looks like this:

```
db=myproject_name
schema=public
host=somehost.com
user=postgres
pass=password
send_tomcat_username_to_db=true
```

Most of the content is straightforward:

- **db** is assigned the name of the project database,
- **schema** is assigned the database schema Lex'it is allowed to access in the project database (note that this allows you to easily keep parts of a database hidden, since Lex'it will only be able to access the specified schema)
- **user** and **pass(word)** are of course needed for Lex'it to access the database
- **send_tomcat_username_to_db** is the only optional parameter. This is needed when one wants to be able to identify (and store) the users identity for logging purposes etc. (see the **Accessing session and user info** section about that)

The `.config.js` file

A default `.config.js` file looks like this:

```
oHiddenTablesList = [];
oShowOnlyTables = [];
```

```
oTableSettingsList = {};
oTableConfigurationList = {};
```

The config file consists of four arrays. The first two arrays are about tables visibility. The one array must be used to declare the names of the tables that must keep hidden, while the other is about tables that must be visible. Those arrays are mutually exclusive: only one can be used at the time. If only a few tables need to be visible, and lots of tables must keep hidden, using `oShowOnlyTables` makes more sense as only a few names will have to be declared. If, on the contrary, many tables must be visible, and only a few must be hidden, one should use `oHiddenTablesList` instead.

The two following arrays are associative arrays:

- The `oTableSettingsList` array is used for global table settings like: table width, header color and buttons, etc.
- The `oTableConfigurationList` array is to be used for configuration at column level, like click events assigned to cells, cells editability, etc.

These arrays are associative arrays, so as to be able to assign a setting to a table name, or to a column name. The table or column name will act as a parameter name (or key), and the setting will act as a parameter value.

Let's give a short example.

Let's say we have a table called 'my_table', with only two columns: a 'word' and its 'ID'. With only two columns our table is quite narrow, so we set it to occupy only 50% of the available screen width. And we want to sort the table by its ID column. Those *table-wide* settings are to be declared in the `oTableSettingsList` array.

The second array – `oTableConfigurationList` – is about configuration *at column level*. Here is the place where one can specify how a columns should render or behave. In this particular case, we want the ID column to be hidden. And we want the column 'word' to be editable, meaning that the user will be able to click on any cell of this column to edit its value. To achieve all that, the configuration file should look like the following:

```
oTableSettingsList = {
    "my_table": {
        "width": "50%",
        "columns_sorting": {"id": "asc"}
    }
};
oTableConfigurationList = {
    "my_table": {
        "id": {
            "visible": false
        },
        "word": {
```

```

        "editable": true
    }
};

```

Remarks

Easy, isn't it? Well, be careful.

Although Lex'it is aiming at making everything as simple as possible (including all kinds of database querying optimizations), there remain things that we need to take care of ourselves. In this case: if a table needs to be editable, in the database it will need a primary key. Typically, the primary key is the ID column.

So all you'll need to do in your database is setting a primary key for the table to be edited, and Lex'it will be able to use it without any further configuration:

```
ALTER TABLE my_table ADD primary key( id );
```

Important note: in its current version (2021-10-11), Lex'it does not yet support primary keys on multiple columns.

Another remark is about the sorting parameter. In the previous example, we've defined sorting in the table-wide setting array. Of course, deciding if some setting belongs to the table-wide settings or to the column settings, is not always self-evident. For example, sorting a table by a given column can be seen as a column setting instead of a table-wide setting. Which is the reason why the API provides us with a parameter to define sorting at column level too:

```

oTableConfigurationList = {
    "my_table": {
        "id": {
            "colsort": "asc"
        }
    }
};

```

But this parameter – dating from the early Lex'it days – is not recommended: sometime one wants to sort a table by multiple columns at the same time, t.i. by a primary column and a secondary column (or even more columns). For example by people's last name (primary) and then by people's first name (secondary). In the past, that was achieved by ordering the columns settings of soring columns in the `oTableSettingsList` by priority: primary sorting columns first, followed by the secondary sorting column, etc.

Lex'it HowTo

Of course, this can be neatly done with a table-wide parameter, which is now the recommended way:

```
oTableSettingsList = {  
    "some_other_table": {  
        "columns_sorting": {"lastname": "asc", "firstname": "asc"}  
    }  
};
```

Call your Lex'it project via an URL

One can open Lex'it straight in a given project (that is: skipping the menu page) by specifying the projectname in the URL:

```
http://<your_host>:8080/lexit2/?db=myproject
```


Full list of configuration parameters

oTableSettingsList parameters

Name	Type	Description
group	string	If one wishes to group some tables of the table selection menu in particular labels, assign each tables a label with the 'group' parameter. All tables sharing the same label value will be shown together under this same group name.
header_color	string	By default, the header of a table had a light grey background color. Give it another color bij assigning a color code to 'header_color'. With value 'auto', Lex'it chooses a color automatically
nice_name	string	Give a table a user friendly name (instead of the possible technical sounding name it might have).
displaylength	string	By default, a table shows 10 rows at the time. Change this number with this setting.
displaylength_menu	string	Modify the 'Show ... rows' menu (in the table header). For 'show everything' use value -1.
viewtype	string	Change the view mode of a table: 'table' (default) or 'form'.
info	string	If one want to show more info about a tablet the tables selection menu in het tabeloverzicht meer info over een tabel te geven, leg men deze info hier vast. Deze informatie verschijnt dus in het menu bij 'Kies een tabel'.
columns_order	array	Change the default columns order (default: null)
columns_sorting	array	Declare the table default sorting. Each column and sort direction is to be given a key/values in an associative array: { colname1: sortdir1, colname2: sortdir2, ...}
grouping_column	string	When a table contains a column by which rows can be grouped (for example a column <i>bundel_title</i> , while rows are about articles as parts of bundels), such a column can be given as a value to the "grouping_column". Beware: this parameter allows for showing grouping labels, not for the grouping itself. The table needs to be sorted by the group column to actually 'group'.
size	string	Width of a tabel. Synonym: "width"

Name	Type	Description
width	string	Width of a tabel. Synonym: "size"
header_height	string	Height of the header above the table; default is 50px
footer_height	string	Height of the footer under the tabel; default is 50px
main_search	boolean	Set if the global search box (which searches each column of the table) needs to be available; default is true
callback	function	callback to be executed each time the table is drawn (initialisation) or redraw (when changing page or refreshing)
repeat_callback	boolean	Repeat the callback each time the table is being redrawn (default: false)
prereset_callback	string	callback to be executed when the Reset button is clicked (can be used to ensure some filters are reapplied etc.)
close_callback	string	callback to be executed when the Close button is clicked
exact_count	boolean	Tell if Lex'it must return an exact table (results) count (default: false)
get_focus_on_tab	boolean	Set if a table is supposed to get focus when pressing TAB (default: true)
refresh_upon_focus	boolean	Refresh a table when the window regains focus (default: true)
reset_button	boolean	show/hide the "RESET" button (default: true)
columns_button	boolean	show/hide the "Column selection" button (default: true)
viewtype_button	boolean	show/hide the "Form/Table view" button (default: true)
refresh_button	boolean	show/hide the "Refresh table" button (default: true)
replace_button	boolean	show/hide the "Search & Replace" button (default: true)
selection_button	boolean	show/hide the "Row selection" button (default: true)
selection_button_active	boolean	Switch the "Row selection" button to ON at startup (default: false = uit)

Name	Type	Description
undo_button	boolean	show/hide the "Undo" button (default: true)
goto_button	boolean	show/hide the "Go to" button (default: true)
help_button	boolean	show/hide the "?" button (default: true)
contextmenu	function	Set a context menu at row/cell click The contextmenu-object has to be define following this API: https://swisnl.github.io/jquery-contextMenu/docs.html
menu	array	Set a pulldown menu for a button in the tabelheader
selected	string	Pre-select an item, in the list of items declared with the 'menu' setting.
keyup	function	Assign functions to keys at keyup event
keydown	function	Assign functions to keys at keydown event

oTableConfigurationList parameters

Name	Type	Description
click	function	Assign a function to be executed at cell click
dblclick	function	Assign a function to be executed at cell doubleclick
bgcolor	string	Assign a background color to a column (use a HEX code like "#123ABC"). One can assign both a single or a pair of colors. Assigning only one color implies that Lex'it will have to compute automatically a second, complementary color, because different colors must be shown on even and odd rows, making the screen more readable. When assigning two color codes, those will be used for even resp. odd rows, and Lex'it won't need to compute a second color.
button	string	Put a button in a column, with the name specified as a parameter value. Instead of setting a name, one can instead have the button use the column's textual context as a label. To achieve that, give this parameter an empty string as a value.
button_tooltip	string	Set a tooltip for a button, to be shown at mouseover.
cell_tooltip	string	Set a tooltip for a cell, to be shown at mouseover.
choosefrom	string	Set the search box of a column to be a select-box. The values to choose from, can be given in two ways: [1] as an empty array, in which case Lex'it will gather the unique column values in the database to build the select box (e.g.: { "choosefrom" : [] }). [2] as an array of strings. Since the select box has "Please choose" as a first value, it must have an underlying neutral value too (which corresponds to the database search value for this select item). This neutral value must be given as the very first member of mentioned array; an empty

Name	Type	Description
		string will do (e.g.: {"choosefrom": ["", "1", "2", "3"]}), in which "" is the underlying neutral search value corresponding to "Please choose").
choosefrom_labels	string	Set the labels for the items of a select box. This is to be used when the database returns technical sounding values to build the select box with, and one want to have human readable values instead to have the user choose from.
class	string	Assign a CSS class to a column, so as to be able to assign styling properties. That is: classes declared in <code>css/lexit_table.css</code> . Lex'it has several default classes available, such as 'inlfont10pt' (to allow rendering of INL font in 10 pt), or 'inlfont' (this one has no font size specified).
nice_name	string	Give a column having a technical sounding name, a human readable / user-friendly name.
colsort	string	If given as a setting for a column, the table will be sorted by this column right at initialization. The allowed values are 'asc', 'desc' or null (default). Beware: for multiple columns sorting, use the "columns_sorting" oTableSettingsList parameter instead.
contextmenu	object	Set a context menu, to appear when right clicking a cell. The contextmenu-object has to be define following this API: https://swisnl.github.io/jQuery-contextMenu/docs.html
copy_upon_insert	object	If set to true, the Search&Add action (in Search and Replace screen) will use this column's value for insertion. Columns having this parameter set to false will instead NOT have their value used at insert.
editable	boolean	Set a column to be manually editable. BEWARE: this parameter only works when the database table has a primary key defined.

Name	Type	Description
editcallback	function	Callback function to be executed right after a cell was manually edited. Beware: this is different from 'editfunc'. 'editfunc' is meant to modify the default behaviour of 'editable'. Instead 'editcallback' is executed as a final step, after 'editfunc'.
editfunc	function	Set a custom function to process cell edition. By default, Lex'it would take the user input and update the corresponding database cell with it. 'editfunc' can be defined to have Lex'it this processed otherwise.
editrefresh	array	Set a list of tables to be refreshed was a cell was edited.
edittrigger	string	As a kind of data validation, one can set a regex as a 'edittrigger'. When the user's textual input in a editable cell matches the regex, the 'editfunc' will be triggered; otherwise it won't.
editerrorhandler	function	Handles to be executed as soon as an error occurs in an editable cell.
ellipsis	boolean	Set ellipsis on or off in a cell with textual content. The full content will only be shown at mouseover.
ellipsis_delay	integer	Set a delay for ellipsis to be activated. Setting some delay allows users to go with the mouse over ellipsis cell without immediately getting the full textual content shown. The text will only unwrapped when the mouse keeps on the cell beyond the set delay.
ellipsis_width	string	'max-width' attribute for ellipsis.
ellipsis_height	string	'max-height' attribute for ellipsis. When the cell content goes beyond this value, a scrollbar will be added to the ellipsis cell.
ellipsis_unwrap	boolean	When true, the textual content of cell will be unwrapped at mouseover; when false, it won't.
ellipsis_keep_selected_unwrapped	boolean	When true, an unwrapped ellipsis cell will

Name	Type	Description
		remain open a mouseout; when false, it won't. Default: true.
filter	string	Set a filter to be applied at initialization time. Beware: to keep the filter active afterwards, you'll need to set 'keepfilter':true.
flexible_visibility	boolean	When 'false', a user won't be able to change the visibility setting of this column (this can be used when some info has to be kept hidden).
keepfilter	boolean	When 'true', a filter (from parameter 'filter':...) will be reapplied when the Reset button is pressed.
searchable	boolean	Set a column to be manually searchable (default: true).
sortable	boolean	Set a column to be manually sortable (default: true).
searchform	function	Set a function to be applied to some filter value as soon as a search is started: this can be used to automatically replace some search terms by other, etc. to ensure a successful search.
render	function	Modify the content of a text cell upon rendering. This function has no influence on the underlying data. <pre>render: function(text){ return text.toUpperCase() }</pre>
textcolor	string	Set the font color in a column.
textfont	string	Set the font-family in a column.
textsize	string	Set the font-size in a column.
textstyle	string	Set the font-style in a column.
textweight	string	Set the font-weight in a column.
validator	string	Set a key that HAS to be pressed when one uses a select menu in a cell. This can be convenient to

Name	Type	Description
		prevent selecting an item by mistake when moving the mouse or so. Pressing the key indicates that one is selecting on purpose.
<code>visible</code>	<code>boolean</code>	Set the visibility of a column. To prevent the user from modifying the default setting, set <code>"flexible_visibility": false</code> as well!
<code>width</code>	<code>string</code>	Set the width of a column. This can be specified in 'px', or as a relative value (in '%' of the table width).

Assign rights to users

Setting rights

Lex'it users have to be declared in two different files:

```
[1] /etc/tomcat/tomcat-user.xml
[2] /etc/lexit2_db_config/users_access.rights
```

In file **[1]** one sets the username/password (as usual in tomcat-users.xml) and one also need to assign the 'lexit_access' role to the user as well, allowing him/her to access the application.

File **[2]** is more about specific project rights. Let's imagine we have a user called 'somebody' and a project called 'someproject'. If we want to grant that user reading rights to our project, we'll need to add the following line to file **[2]**:

```
somebody=someproject_read
```

Of course, it is possible to assign even more right: writing right, of even more: all rights, including deleting:

```
somebody=someproject_write
somebody=someproject_all
```

Since some users might need to have the same rights in all projects, it is also possible to declare super-readers or even super-users. The first one can read everything but can't edit, the second type is allowed to read, write and delete:

```
somebody=someproject_superuser
somebody=someproject_superuser
```

Activating rights

Finally, the user rights need to be activated, whenever those were modified. To do so, go to the Lex'it main menu (that is: the lex'it link without the .../?db=projectname part. There, you'll need to click the 'reset user rights' link in the goodies.

Goodies en tools

[Login overzicht](#) : Overzicht actieve accounts (wordt om de 2 sec bijgewerkt)
[Reset user rights](#) : Toegangsrechten resetten (klik alleen als het nodig is, geen speelgoed!)

If you don't activate the user rights, modifications to file **[2]** won't have any effect at all.

The API

The API provides for functions to deal with different aspects of the tables. The most important are:

- The header
- The search boxes
- The table body (cells, rows, columns)
- Dialogs
- Functions and callbacks

The Lex'it API is built upon the native Datatables API, which means that not only the Lex'it functions but also all the native Datatables functions can be used.

The current Datatable API is described at: <https://datatables.net/reference/api/>

First things first: open a table

A table can be opened the following way:

```
fn.callDatabase(tablename);
```

Of course, one can specify some filtering, and even give a callback to be executed as soon as the table is opened and initialized:

```
fn.callDatabase(tablename, {"somecolumn_name": value}, function(){
    // do something when table is open
} [, oExtraSettings]);
```

The `oExtraSettings` parameter is optional, but allows to set the position of a table, its view mode, its display length etc. from the very start. Here are the available parameters, all to be declared in an associative array:

Parameter	Type	Default value	Description
pane	string	all elements	Elements to use in the rendering of the top pane. This string must consist of a combinations of letters symbolizing the needed functionalities, like: 'i' for table information summary, 'f' for filtering input, 'l' for length changing input control, 'p' for pagination control.
top	string		Vertical position of the left upper corner of the table (px)
left	string		Horizontal position of the left upper corner of the table (px)
viewtype	string	table	'table' or 'form'
displaylength	int	10	Number of rows to show at once in the table
ignore_initialisaton_filters	boolean	false	if true, the default filters (stated in config file) to be set at initialization time will be omitted

Lex'it HowTo

This function will open a table in the current tab. If one want to open a table in a new tab, it can be done as well:

```
fn.callDatabaseInNewTab(tablename, {"somecolumn_name": value}, oExtraSettings,  
projectName);
```

Close a table

Of course, if we can open a table, we can close it too!

```
fn.closeTable(t, fnCallback);
```

Project wide settings

Setting a project title

Usually, the title shown in the Lex'it GUI is the content of the “name” parameter assigned to the project in file `/webapps/lexit2_config/projects_overview.js`. But if needed, it is possible to modify the title shown programmatically:

```
fn.setProjectTitle(sProjectName, sColor, sFontSize, sFontWeight);
```

A background color can be set for the screen:

```
fn.setBackgroundColor(sColor);
```

Table global settings

General settings

Is a table loaded?

Do you need to know programmatically if a table was loaded already? Do this:

```
if (fn.tableExists(t) ) { ... }
```

View type

The Lex'it GUI gives two viewing type for table content: 'table' view or 'form' view. This is set manually by the user. Which mode is on, can be read by the following function:

```
var sViewMode = fn.getViewType(t);
if (sViewMode == 'form') {

    fn.message("OK", "You're viewing the table in form mode now!");
}
```

Row selection

The Lex'it GUI has a 'row selection mode', that can be switched on or off by the user. When turned on, a user can click rows for selection without triggering function usually attached to rows (like editable, click, etc.). Check if this mode is on or off by calling:

```
fn.rowsSelectionIsAllowed(t);
```

Is a table empty?

A reliable way of knowing programmatically if a query has returned any results, is by calling:

```
if (fn.tableIsEmpty(t) ){ ... }
```

Table results count quality

Lex'it always tries to count the number of results as fast as possible. To do so, it will often choose to compute an estimated count instead of an exact count, which is much, much faster. However, this might sometimes not be convenient. If you need Lex'it to (always) return exact counts instead of (much faster) estimated counts, proceed this way:

```
oTableSettingsList = {
    "some_table": {
        "exact_count": true
    }
};
```

Positioning

Table absolute positioning

A user can set the position of a table by dragging it with the mouse, or one can set the absolute screen position programmatically. And of course one can read out the table position.

```
fn.getTablePosition(t);  
  
// this returns an associative array like: {top: ..., left: ...}
```

Table relative positioning

One can set the position of a table relatively to other tables. For example, one can align two tables horizontally, in such a way that those appear side to side:

```
fn.alignTables(t1, t2, fnCallback);
```

There also exist a vertical equivalent, allowing to put to tables on top of each other:

```
fn.pileupTables(t1, t2, fnCallback);
```

Saving and retrieving settings

Read the configuration settings

In the **My first project** section of this document, we saw that configuration is set in two main arrays, one for table wide configuration and one for column level configuration.

The *table wide* configuration can be retrieved by:

```
var oTableSettings = conf.getTableSettings(sTablename);
```

The column level configuration is to be retrieved by:

```
var oTableConfig = conf.getTableConfig(sTablename);  
var oColumnConfig = conf.getColumnConfig(oTableConfig, sColumnName);
```

Restore the configuration settings

```
fn.resetTable(sTableName, fnCallback);
```

Save table extra settings (position etc.) for later re-use

Tables settings consist of its position ({top: ... left: ...}), its view type (table, form), its display length, its size.

When a table needs to be closed, and one wants to be able to re-open it with the very same settings (like screenposition, etc.), this is what needs to be done:

```
// save the table settings before closing your table:
var oExtraSettings = fn.getTableExtraSettings(sTablename)

// now close it
fn.closeTable(sTablename);

// do other cool stuff
// ...

// open the table again with the settings saved before:

fn.callDatabase(tablename, {"somecolumn_name": value}, function(){
    // do something when table is open
}, oExtraSettings);
```

Save and restore table state

With table state, we mean: the active sorting columns, the active filters (=search values) applied to the table, and its display position (shown page). It is possible to save this table state and restore it later on:

```
// save current table state
fn.saveTableState(sTableName);

// do something else with the table
// ...

// restore the original state of the table
fn.restoreTableState(sTable)
```

Tabel header

Ways of setting header buttons

Usually, buttons are declared in the `oTableSettingsList`. Such buttons will be available in the GUI from initialization time:

```
oTableSettingsList:{
  "button_0": {
    "name": "put the button label here",
    "click": function(t){
      // do something
    }
  }
}
```

However, it is also possible to add buttons later on. In that case, the buttons name and behavior have to be set into an associative array, which can be given as an argument to the following function:

```
var oButtonConfig = {
  "name": "put the button label here",
  "click": function(t){
    // do something
  }
}
fn.addCustomButton(sSomeTableName, oButtonConfig);
```

Add a SELECT button

Give the button a `name` and define the options of the select menu by giving up each option name as a key, and its behavior as a function (with the table variable as a parameter):

```
"button_0": {
  "name": "Name of the button",
  "menu": {
    "option name 1": function(t){
      // do something cool here
    },
    "option name 2": function(t){
      // do something else here
    },
    // if needed, set option to be selected by default
    "selected": "option name 2"
  }
}
```


Implement a button for row duplication

Row duplication can be implemented in a generic way by using the Lex'it native function

`fn.duplicateRecord()`:

```
"button_0": {
  "name": "Duplicate row",
  "click": function(t){
    var nRow = fn.getFirstSelectedRowNodeFrom(t);
    var iCounter = fn.getDataFromCellInRowNode(nRow, "counter");

    fn.duplicateRecord(t, null, null, iCounter, function(response){

      // arg #2 with null value means we won't skip any field (t.i. the whole
      row with all its cells will be duplicated, except the primary key of course)

      // arg #3 with null value means we rely on the primary key ('counter'), so
      we don't need to declared some other serial typed column to act as such
      (which is needed when a table lacks a primary key)

      fn.refreshTable(t, function(){
        fn.message("Nieuwe rij", "The duplicated row has
          id counter="+response);
      });
    });
  },
}
```

Click on a button programmatically

This can be done by calling this function, specifying the table and the button id in the DOM tree:

```
fn.clickOnButton(sTableName, sButtonId)
```

Modify the name/style of a button programmatically

Normally, the name of a button is set in the table declaration in the configuration file. But it might be convenient to be able to change the name of a button. For example, if a button is used to turn on a function, it might be convenient if the button label 'says' that the function is on, etc. That can be done by calling this function:

```
fn.setCustomButtonName(sTableName, iButtonNumber, sNewName);
```

The same can be achieved for the button style:

```
fn.setCustomButtonCss(sTableName, iButtonNumber, sProperty, sNewValue);
```

If one wants to read the current style of a button, one should call:

```
fn.getCustomButtonCss (sTableName, iButtonNumber, sProperty);
```

Finally, the index of a button with a given name (or the other way round) can be retrieved with:

```
fn.getIndexOfButtonNamed(sTableName, sName);  
fn.getNameOfButtonAtIndex(sTableName, iIndex);
```

Filters & search boxes in the GUI

One can programmatically change the content of a search box, or read what's inside.

First, the search boxes can be reset by:

```
fn.resetAllFilters(sSomeTable, true);
```

And search values can be put into the search boxes by doing the following:

```
fn.setFilters(sSomeTable, {"column1": value1, "column2": value2}, true);
```

The filter behind the 'Search whole table' field can be set too:

```
fn.setGlobalFilter(sTable, sSearchTerm);
```

The above example operates **both** on the search engine as on the search boxes (updating the search boxes is actually the meaning of the 'true' value; setting the filters silently with 'false' instead).

The filters currently active in the search engine can be retrieved by:

```
var aSearchFilters = fn.getFilters(sSomeTable);
```

This function, however, has no access to the search boxes of the GUI.
But their content can be programmatically read by doing the following:

```
var searchBoxValue = fn.getValueOfFilterBox(sSomeTable, sColumnName);
```

And if need, its type can be retrieved too. The following function will return 'checkbox', 'select' or 'text':

```
var searchBoxType = fn.getTypeOfFilterBox(sSomeTablename, sColumnName);
if (searchBoxType == 'select') {
    fn.message("Info", "You just click on a select box");
}
```

Modify a user's search query programmatically, before search is fired

Sometimes search queries require some pre-processing before the search effectively starts. Because of the necessity to meet the data format in the database, for example.

Let's say we have a table containing a list of lemmata containing some diacritics (é, à, ü, etc.) coded as html-entities: searching for a lemma containing a -é- will fail, because the -é- of the search query won't match the equivalent html-entity (t.i. é). To solve that, one can set a 'searchform' in the table configuration:

```
"lemma": {
  "editable": true,
  "searchform": function(value){
    value = value.replace("é", "&eacute;");
    value = ...
    return value;
  }
}
```

In the example here above, the 'searchform' parameter makes sure that diacritics occurring in the search term of column 'lemma' are automatically re-written into corresponding html entities.

Modifying the filter silently (that is: without modifying the search boxes)

Filters can be all erased silently (despite the search boxes being filled in!):

```
fn. clearAllFilters(t);
```

To add filters to the table, do:

```
fn.addFilters(t, {"column_name1": val1, "column_name2": val2});
```

The command hereabove won't change the existing filters on other columns. If you need to erase all pre-existing filters, do instead:

```
fn.setFilters(t, {"column_name1": val1, "column_name2": val2});
```

Query builder

Lex'it offers query building help, that is: when one strikes the CTRL key when clicking into a search box, a query builder popup opens.

Out-of-the box, the query build gathers the most frequent values of a column and allows to build a query with a selection of those values, combined in a single regular expression. Additionally, one can require exact matching, or negative matching (that is, excluding what matches from the results).

This process can be fine-tuned with some configuration:

The `query_builder_settings` parameter can be used to declare some settings as an associative array:

Parameter name	Default value	Effect
<code>grid</code>	Boolean: <code>false</code>	Way of rendering the values to choose from: If <code>false</code> , show the values as a list. If <code>true</code> , show those as a grid.
<code>preselected</code>	Empty array	List of pre-selected values, to be marked as chosen right from the start
<code>autostart</code>	Boolean: <code>true</code>	Behaviour after some query was built: If <code>true</code> , start the search as soon as OK is clicked. If <code>false</code> : the user will have to start the search manually (by pressing ENTER or so)

With the `query_builder_values` parameter, one can declare an associative array of search terms (keys) and the string into which those must be converted (values), ensuring a successful search.

Finally the `query_builder_processor` parameter can host a function, allowing to process the query built in the query builder in any way not supported by the default parameters or settings. The function takes the query as input string, and gives the modified query back as output string.

Tabel-body

Dealing with rows

Which row is now selected?

```
var nRow = fn.getActiveRowNode(t);
fn.message("OK", "You're just clicked row ID "+ nRow.id );
```

Iterating over rows

This can be done two ways, depending on the type of object:

```
// iterating over row nodes
$(aRows).each(function(){
    ...
});

// iterating over rows in a DataTables instance
oRows.every(function(){
    ...
});
```

Get total number of rows

```
// in whole table
t.page.info().recordsTotal;

// displayed on screen
t.rows().count();
```

Get all visible rows

One can get all visible rows of a table (so as to perform some operation with those) by using

`fn.getAllRowNodes(t):`

```
var aRows = fn.getAllRowNodes(t);
var aApprovedRows = new Array();

$(aRows).each(function(){

    var thisRow = this;

    var bApproved = fn.getDataFromCellInRowNode(thisRow, "approved");
    var sId = fn.getDataFromCellInRowNode(thisRow, "id");

    if (bApproved == 't' || bApproved == true){

        aApprovedRows.push(sId);
    }
});
```

Get all visible rows meeting some filters

One can select all rows, given some values expected in some given columns. The result is an array that can be used the same way as the result set of `fn.getAllRowNodes(t)`:

```
var aRows = fn.getAllRowNodesWhere(t, {"col1": value1, "col2": value2});
$(aRows).each(function() {
    // do something
})
```

Select or unselect row programmatically

Rows can be selected or unselected one at the time...

```
fn.selectRowNode(sTableName, iRowNumber);
fn.unselectRowNode(sTableName, iRowNumber);
```

...or all at once:

```
fn.unselectAllRowNodes(sTableName);
```

Dealing with cells

Get a cell and its type, given a row node and a column name

```
var nCell = fn.getCellInRowNode(nRow, sColumnName);
var sCellType = fn.getCellNodeType(nRow, sColumnName);
// this function returns 'text', 'checkbox', 'selectbox' or 'unknown'
```

Assign a mouse event to a cell

To assign a mouse event (`click`, `dblclick`, `mouseenter`, `mouseleave`, ...) to a cell, just use it as a parameter name in the cell configuration:

```
"tablename": {
    "columnname": {
        "click": function(t, n){
            // do something
        }
    }
}
```

Assign a mouse event to an element in a cell

Let's imagine we've got cells containing not only text data, but also some clickable icons for calling some functions. If a cell only contains an icon, there is no problem at all: the icon click event will be caught as a cell click event, since the icon is part of a cell.

But if a cell contains both text AND some icon at the same time, we do have a challenge. Since Lex'it attaches mouse event to cells, it is primarily impossible to assign a function to only *a part* of a cell, like a clickable icon from our example.

One way to solve this, is retrieving the true target of the click event, as soon as it is caught as a cell click event. The event variable can be retrieved as a 3rd function parameter, after the usual parameter `t` and `n`:

```
"tablename": {
  "columnname": {
    "click": function(t, n, e) { ... }
  }
}
```

Let's say our icon is implemented in our text cells as button with classname 'hello'. We can verify if the icon was clicked the following way:

```
"tablename": {
  "columnname": {
    "click": function(t, n, e){
      var bIconClicked = $(e.target).is("button") &&
        $(e.target).hasClass("hello");

      if (bIconClicked){
        console.log("the icon was clicked!");
      }
    }
  }
}
```

Highlighting data in cells

Selected parts of the cell textual content can be highlighted. This is especially handy to show that some text has been selected or so.

Let's say some words were selected in a cell. The onsets and offsets of the selected words can easily be retrieved (see section **Read data / Read selected text in cell**).

The onsets/offsets must be put into an array, and given to the `fn.getHighlight` function as a parameter so as to highlight the words:

```
tablename: {
  columnname: {
    "click": function(t, n, value){
```



```

        // get the full text content of the cell
        var sText = fn.getDataFromSiblingNode(nRow, sColumnName);

        // get the selected text
        var oSelection = fn.getSelectedTextInNode(n);

        // extract the onset/offset of the selected text
        var iStart = oSelection.start;
        var iEnd = oSelection.end;
        var aOnsetsOffsets = [ [iStart, iEnd] ];

        // apply highlighting between this onset/offset
        var sHighlightText = fn.getHighlight(sText, aOnsetsOffsets, sColor);

        // put the highlighted text back into the cell
        fn.putDataIntoCellNode(nRow, sColumnName, sHighlightText);
    }
}

```

Highlighting can be removed too:

```

// get the text content of a cell
var sText = fn.getDataFromSiblingNode(nRow, sColumnName);

// remove the highlighting
var sCleanText = fn.removeHighlight(sText);

// put the cleaned up text back into the cell
fn.putDataIntoCellNode(nRow, sColumnName, sCleanText);

```

Sorting data

Normally, a table is sorted from the configuration by setting the `column_sorting` parameter. But it is possible to change the way a table is sorted programmatically afterwards:

```
fn.setSorting(sTablename, {"column1": "asc", "column2": "desc", etc.});
```

Read data

Read text from cells, columns, of rows

Given a cell node or a row node, one can read data from that node or its siblings by calling the following functions:

```

// get data from a cell, given a cell node
var sData = fn.getDataFromCellNode(nCell);

// get data from a cell, given its name and the row node it belongs to
var sData = fn.getDataFromCellInRowNode(nRow, sColumnName);

// get data from a cell, given its name and the node of another cell
// (this is typically the type of function to call when one has
// clicked some cell and we want to know the corresponding row ID, which

```

```
// is stored in other column of the same row)
var sData = fn.getDataFromSiblingNode(nCell, sOtherColumnName);
```

A particular case is that of checkboxes. Some function makes sure their value is read in a reliable way:

```
var bTrueOrFalse = fn.getCheckboxValue(nCell);
```

It is also possible to get the data of all cells of a column, by specifying its name:

```
var aData = fn.getDataFromColumn(sSomeTable, sColumnName);
```

The functions here above are about reading data from screen. But one can also read a row straight from the database without displaying it. The result is stored into an associative array. Which function to use depends on the data at your disposal (an row ID or some other field value to match):

```
var oRow = fn.getRecord(sSomeTablename, sRecordId, fnCallback, fnErrorHandler);

var oRow = fn.getRecordGivenFieldValues(sSomeTablename, {"column": valuetomatch},
fnCallback, fnErrorHandler);
```

Read selected text in cell

If one selects some text in a cell (by highlighting it just like in a Word document or such), that can be detected. Typically, this to be implemented as a click event on a column. For example:

```
tablename: {
  columnname: {
    "click": function(t, n, value){
      var oSelection = fn.getSelectedTextInNode(n);

      var sText = oSelection.text;
      var iStart = oSelection.start;
      var iEnd = oSelection.end;

      fn.message("Info", "You selected the text "+sText+" starting
        at index "+iStart+" and finishing at index "+iEnd);
    }
  }
}
```

A special case is selecting by clicking onto a word. In that can the word might not be highlighted, but Lex'it can automatically search for the edges (begin, end) of the word clicked upon and return its full string:

```

tablename: {
    columnname: {
        "click": function(t, n, value){
            var oSelection = fn.getWordClickedUponInNode(n);

            var sWord = oSelection.text;
            var iStart = oSelection.start;
            var iEnd = oSelection.end;

            fn.message("Info", "You clicked the word "+sWord+" starting
                at index "+iStart+" and finishing at index "+iEnd);
        }
    }
}

```

Read id's of rows

Id's of rows on screen can be read by calling this function:

```

fn.getIdFromDatabase(sSomeTableName, {"column": valuetomatch}, fnCallback,
fnErrorHandler);

```

Write data

Write data in editable cells

There are two main different ways of writing data into cells.

- The first one is about putting data into screen cells, without modifying the underlying database. Such an operation can be convenient for modifying the text format (eg. adding some style).
- The second one is about putting data into the database, without modifying the screen cells. If the screen cells need are visible at the time of writing into the database, one can reflect the changes by refreshing the table (`fn.refreshTable`).

Putting some content into screen cells is taken care of by this function:

```

fn.putDataIntoCellNode(nRow, sColumnName, sContent);

```

For checkboxes, some special functions are needed:

```

fn.toggleCheckbox(nRow, sColumnName, fnCallback);

fn.uncheckCheckboxes(nMixed, aListOfColumns, fnCallback);

```

Sending data to the database

Writing into the database is taken care of by the following set of functions. Here is how to insert data. Only the first two sets of parameters are compulsory:

```
fn.insertIntoDatabase(sSomeTablename, {"column1": newvalue1, "column2": newvalue2},
returnField, fnCallback, fnErrorHandler);
```

We can update the following way. Which function to use depends on the reference data one has at one's disposal, a node or some field values:

```
fn.updateDatabaseGivenANode(nMixed, {"column": newvalue}, fnCallback,
fnErrorHandler);

fn.updateDatabaseGivenFieldValues(sSomeTablename, {"column1": valuetomatch,
"column2": othervaluetomatch}, {"column1": newvalue1, "column2": newvalue2},
fnCallback, fnErrorHandler);
```

Context menus in cells or rows

Context menus can be set on any cells of a table. So do so, two things need to be set: a list of menu items, and a callback which will perform actions assigned to the items of the context menu items.

Here is a simple example: we set a context menu on column/cell 'lemma'. When clicked upon with the mouse context menu button, the user is given a menu with two items to choose from:

[1] show the paradigm of the lemma or [2] open the dictionary article of that lemma

```
"table_name": {
  "lemma": {
    "contextmenu": {
      // here the structure of the context menu is given
      "items": {
        // here we set keys to which user friendly names
        // are assigned
        "wordform": {"name": "Show wordforms"},
        "dict":      {"name": "Open dictionary"}
      },
      // callback function called after the user has chosen
      // an option in the context menu
      "callback": function(table, node, key, options){
        if (key == 'wordforms')
        {
          var sLemId =
            fn.getDataFromCellInRowNode(table, node, "lemma_id");

          fn.callDatabase("wordforms", {"lemma_id": sLemId });
        }
        else if (key == 'dict')
        {
          var pid =
            fn.getDataFromCellInRowNode(table, node, "pid");
          var url = "http://dictionary.url?pid=" + pid;
          window.open(url);
        }
      }
    }
  }
}
```

```
}
}
```

Note: if the “name” of an item needs some html (like “” etc.), make sure to add “isHtmlName”: true, like this:

```
“items”: {
  // here we set keys to which user friendly names
  // are assigned
  “wordform”: {“name”: “Show <B>wordforms</B>”,
               “isHtmlName”: true}
}
```

Note: context menus in Lex’it are implemented with the plugin ‘jQuery contextMenu’. Items can be defined following the native API of that plugin, which allows for more than is described here (<https://swisnl.github.io/jQuery-contextMenu/docs.html>).

Refreshing a table, or only single rows

If one wants to make sure that the screen rows reflect the current content of the database, one can call the `fn.refreshTable()` function. For sake of speed, Lex’it won’t necessarily return an exact table count: an approximate table count is much faster to get, and mostly good enough for paging aims. In case in which an exact count is required, do the following:

```
fn.forceExactCount(); // now Lex’it knows the next refreshTable call must be exact!
fn.refreshTable(t);
```

The same can also be done for a single row, for example when one expects only that row to have changed. The advantage of refreshing only one row (instead of the whole table) is obviously speed, since sorting and such don’t apply to a single row:

```
fn.callRecord(nRow, aColumnsToUpdate, fnCallback, fnErrorHandler)
```

Remove data

Remove a row

A row can be removed by calling one of the following functions, depending on the data at one’s disposal, a row or some particular field values:

```
fn.removeFromDatabaseGivenANode(nRow, fnCallback, fnErrorHandler);

fn.removeFromDatabaseGivenFieldValues(sSomeTablename, {“column1”: value1,
“column2”: value2}, fnCallback, fnErrorHandler);
```

Implement an autocomplete in an editable cell

When one wants to get suggestions when typing some data in a cell, an autocomplete function has to be implemented. First we need a database function to provide the data to choose from:

```
CREATE OR REPLACE FUNCTION api.get_lemmata(text)
  RETURNS text AS
$BODY$
  SELECT string_agg( modern_lemma || '/' || lemma_gigpos || ':' || lemma_id ,
'|') -- output (=suggestions) must be pipe separated
  FROM (
    SELECT modern_lemma, lemma_gigpos, lemma_id
    FROM lemmata
    WHERE modern_lemma ~* ('^'||$1)
    ORDER BY modern_lemma
    LIMIT 10
  ) x;
$BODY$
LANGUAGE sql VOLATILE
COST 100;
```

When we've got that, implementing the autocomplete is easy:

```
fn.setAutoComplete("someTable", "correction", false, "api.get_lemmata");
```

This will implement an autocomplete in table 'someTable', column 'correction', and the suggestions will be provided by the database function 'api.get_lemmata'.

Beware: some functions might issue other separators. Those can be specified with two additional parameters, `sPrimarySeparator` and `sSecondarySeparator`opt:

```
fn.setAutoComplete("someTable", "correction", false, "api.get_lemmata",
sPrimarySeparator, sSecondarySeparator);
```

By default, the autocomplete expects two things before getting active:

- * it requires an input length of 2 chars
- * and it will wait 750 milliseconds after the last key strike (which allows the user to type several chars without triggering the autocomplete, as it will start working only after the delay following the last key strike)

The default values of these parameters can be modified thanks to two extra function parameters, `iMinLength` and `iDelay`:

```
fn.setAutoComplete("someTable", "correction", false, "api.get_lemmata",
sPrimarySeparator, sSecondarySeparator, iMinLength, iDelay);
```

Wild cards in columns configuration

If one wants to assign some setting to lots of columns at once, one can use wild cards:

```
"": {  
  parameter: value  
}
```

Callbacks

Table callbacks

Typically, table callbacks have to be set in the `oTableSettingsList`.

For several stages of the tables rendering, one can set callbacks. For example, let's say one wants to change the color of some cells or rows when those meet some constraint. One will have to declare a callback function in the following way:

```
Tablename: {
    "callback": function(t){
        var oRows = fx.getAllRows(t);
        oRows.every(function(){
            var nCellSelector =
                $( fx.getNode(oThisRow) ).find("td");
            if (some constraint) {
                nCellSelector.find("input").css("color", "green");
            }
        });
    },
    "repeat_callback": true
}
```

The `repeat_callback` part makes sure that the callback is not called only once (say: at table initialization) but always now and in the future, at every new table draw event. Of course, leaving out the `repeat_callback` part is the way to set a initialization callback.

Next to the draw callback, have callbacks targeting other events like clicking the reset or close button: `prereset_callback`, `close_callback`. Those callbacks must be declared the same way as above (though the `repeat_callback` part won't be needed there):

```
Tablename: {
    "prereset_callback": function(t){
        // do something upon reset, but before table is called
    }
}
```

Some callback can also be called when some user closes a table:

```
Tablename: {
    "close_callback": function(t){
        // do something when table is closed
    }
}
```


Function callbacks

Lots of Lex'it functions allow a callback to be given as an argument. That way, Lex'it will wait till the function is fully executed before executing the code given as a callback.

```
fn.callDatabase(t, ..., function(){  
    // some code for your callback  
});
```

Sadly, for multiple reasons, some function lack the possibility to give a callback as an argument. But in many cases, we have a workaround: set a so called 'draw callback'. That is a function to be called as soon as the table is redrawn, for example when browsing the table or refreshing it.

The following declares a draw callback for table `t`. Note that this works only once. As soon as this callback was called once, it won't be called again.

```
fn.addDrawCallback(t, function(){  
    // do something here  
});
```

Updating a table configuration after initialization

Updating a table configuration can be done by calling the `conf.changeTableConfigValue` function. For example, if one wants to assign a function to a click event on column 'some_column' in table 'some_table', one should write:

```
conf.changeTableConfigValue("some_table", "some_column",
    "click", function(){
        do something();
    }
);
```

Some modifications in the configuration require a table to be removed from the screen to be able to update it. Modified columns visibility settings is such a situation. In such a case, one needs to destroy the table, modify the settings and call the table again. Schematically:

```
// first destroy the table (on screen)
tb.destroyTable("some_table", function(){

    // modify the configuration
    conf.changeTableConfigValue( ... );

    // call the table back
    fn.callDatabase(("some_table", ... )
});
```

Some complications can occur when more tables are open and visible on screen at the same time. That is: destroying a table and calling it again will cause that table to be appended at the bottom of the screen, underneath all other tables. If this table was (before destruction) first on top of the other tables, the users might get confused as the table now reappears at the bottom when it is called again.

To solve this particular problem, one should read the table position before destruction, and re-apply the table position to the table when it is called (and shown) again. Fortunately, it is quite easy to do. Read the position with `fn.getTablePosition` and give the result as a fourth argument to the `fn.callDatabase` function:

```
tb.destroyTable("some_table", function(){

    // read the table position
    var oPosition = fn.getTablePosition(t);
    conf.changeTableConfigValue( ... );

    // apply the table position
    fn.callDatabase(("some_table", oSomeFilters, function() {}, oPosition );
});
```

Error handlers

Error handlers can be set in different ways: in the configuration of a column, or as a function parameter:

Table columns error handlers

When a column is `editable`, just add a `editerrorhandler` key with some handler as a value:

```
"editable": true,
"editerrorhandler": function(jqXHR, textStatus, errorThrown){
    fn.message("Error!", "Something went wrong! More info:" +
        JSON.stringify( err["jqXHR"] ) )
    };
},
```

Function error handlers

Quite some functions allow for a custom error handler to be declared as an argument.

The error handler is to be called with one argument:

```
fn.callFunction(sFunctionName, [...], function(response){...}, function(errorInfo){...});
```

Where `errorInfo` is an object containing at least the following keys, giving access to extra info in the corresponding values:

```
errorInfo = {
    "jqXHR": ..., "textStatus": ..., "errorThrown": ...,
    "lexit_function": "fn.callFunction"
}
```

The `"lexit_function"` key indicates which function caused the error.

Dialogs

Classic dialogs

Lex'it support several kinds of dialogs:

The classic JavaScript functions `alert()` and `confirm()` have their Lex'it equivalents, provided with some callbacks:

```
fn.message(sTitle, sMessage, fnFunction)
fn.confirm(sTitle, sMessage, fnFunction, fnCancelFunction)
```

The callbacks of these (and the following functions) can process the response:

```
fn.confirm(sTitle, sMessage, function(resp){
    var answer = resp;
});
```

Entering data in a dialog

Data to be typed in

Lex'it has some more functions meant to prompt the user to enter information.

The first of those functions – `fn.prompt()` – displays a dialog in which the user is asked to fill in some fields. The field labels and corresponding default values (most of the time an empty value) must be given as separate arrays.

```
var aFieldNames = ["first name", "last name"];
var aValues = ["", ""];

fn.prompt(sTitle, aFieldNames, aValues, fnFunction, fnCancelFunction, bTextarea,
aColsAndRows)
```

Fields can be of different types. Given the format of the values, Lex'it will adapt automatically:

- if a value is an array, Lex'it will display a select-box
- if a value is a Boolean, Lex'it will display a checkbox
- if a balue is a string of a number, Lex'it will display a text field

Some particularities:

- In case of a select-box, a value to be selected by default must have the string ``::selected`` attached.
- To disable a field (allowing the user to see its default value, without being able to change it), its value must have the string ``::disabled`` attached.

- If one wants a datepicker, attach the string ``::datepicker'` to the field value.
- If a field must be a textarea, just attach the ``::textarea'` string to its value.

```
var aFieldNames = ["name", "gender", "employed"];
var aValues = [ "",
                ["male::selected", "female", "other"],
                true
              ];

fn.prompt(sTitle, aFieldNames, aValues, fnFunction, fnCancelFunction [, bTextarea,
aColsAndRows])
```

Data to be chosen out of a list of items

The second type of function displays a dialog in which the user is asked to select one or more items.

The items to choose from must be given as an array list, and if some value(s) must be pre-selected, that can be specified in another array:

```
var aAllOptions = ["nike", "addidas", "other"];
var aAlreadyChosen = ["other"]; // pre-selected

fn.promptSelect(sTitle, aAllOptions, aAlreadyChosen, fnFunction, fnCancelFunction,
mSelectionMode);
```

We have to pay attention to the `mSelectionMode` parameter. Note his Hungarian notation prefix `m` indicates it can have various types:

* It can be a Boolean. When true, the dialog will be closed as soon as an item is clicked. When false, the dialog will remain open, allowing a 'multiple choice' selection.

```
fn.promptSelect(sTitle, ["item 1", "item 2"], [],
function(aChoice){
    // a choice was made, do something with it now
},
function(){
    fn.message("OK", "Operation cancelled by the user.");
},
true // click is choosing, as the dialog will close directly upon click!
);
```

* It can be a function. Behaves like false, and the function is executed as a callback, with the selected text as function parameter.

```
fn.promptSelect(sTitle, ["item 1", "item 2"], [],
function(aChoice){
    // a choice was made, do something with it now
},
function(){
    fn.message("OK", "Operation cancelled by the user.");
},
function(selectedText){
```

Lex'it HowTo

```
        // do something when the item specified in selectedText
        // is clicked, like giving extra info etc.
    }
};
```

Data to be sorted

The third type of function displays a list of items to be sorted. It comes with a help function to process the response:

```
fn.promptReorder(sTitle, aArrayToResort, function(){

    var aNewOrderIdx = fn.getPromptBoxOrder();
    var aResortedArray = fn.processPromptBoxOrder(aPromptBoxOrder, aArrayToResort);

}, fnCancelFunction);
```

Menu dialog

A special type of dialog is 'askToChoose', which asks the user to make some choice, which will automatically triggers a function assigned to that particular choice:

```
var oOptions = {
    "choice 1": function(){ // do something },
    "choice 2": function(){ // do something else }
};

fn.askToChoose(sTitle, sMessage, oOptions);
```

Note that this functionality is also available in `fn.promptSelect(...)`, when using its `mSelectionMode` parameter as a callback function.

```
fn.promptSelect(sTitle, ["choice 1", "choice 2"], [], fnFunction, fnCancelFunction,
    function(selectedText){
        if (selectedText == "choice 1") { // do something }
        if (selectedText == "choice 2") { // do something else }
    }
);
```

Get rid of the 'OK' button

By default, most dialog functions display an 'OK' button and a 'Cancel' button. The 'Cancel' button is compulsory as one must be capable of canceling some action. On the contrary, the 'OK' button can be gotten rid of. For example, in a `fn.promptSelect()` call, one of the given options might fulfill the role of an 'OK' button, causing the default 'OK' button to be unnecessary.

Getting rid of the default 'OK' button is easy: just replace the corresponding callback by `null`.

```
fn.promptSelect(sTitle, aAllOptions, aAlreadyChosen,  
  NULL, function(){ // cancel function });
```

Closing a dialog programmatically

The dialog currently in front can be closed by calling:

```
fn.closeDialog();
```

Which dialog is opened makes no difference. Any dialog will be closed by this command.

Show a progress indicator and hide it

Show it with:

```
fn.showProcessingMsg(sTableName);
```

And hide it with:

```
fn.removeProcessingMsg(sTableName);
```

Key events

Assign even to some key

Any table can be assigned functions to be performed when some keys are pressed. Such functions must be declared in the `oTableSettingsList` array:

```
oTableSettingsList = {
    mytable: { // the following will work only when this table is active
        "keyup": {
            "a": function(t){
                // do something when 'a' is pressed
            }
        }
    }
};
```

In some circumstances, the key events need to be suppressed, for example when some editable cell be being edited while the key event is supposed to operation in completely different circumstances. In such can, one can use the `editFunctionIsActiveNow()` function:

```
oTableSettingsList = {
    mytable: {
        "keyup": {
            "b": function(t){
                If (editFunctionIsActiveNow() ) {
                    // do nothing, because some cell is edited now!
                }
                else {
                    // carry on: do something because 'b' was pressed
                }
            }
        }
    }
};
```

Trigger a key event programmatically

We can trigger some pre-defined key event by specifying its key code and DOM element to trigger the key strike upon. The last parameter (some DOM element node that is part of `nElement`) is optional.

```
fn.triggerKeyStrikeOnElement (iKeyCode, nElement, nSubElement);
```


Detect which key was striken

First, one can test if a particular key was pressed:

```
if ( kf.isPressed("alt") ){  
    // do something  
}
```

But Lex'it can also tell which key was pressed when no one else knows:

```
var sPressedKey = kf._getPressedKey();  
fn.message("Info", sPressedKey + " was pressed!");
```

Calling external resources:

Call a database function and get its output

Calling a database function is done by specifying the name of that function and also the database schema it is part of, separated by a dot just like in Postgres.

```
fn.callFunction(sFunctionName, aFunctionArguments, fnCallback, fnErrorHandler)
```

The function output (if relevant), which is put in an associative array, can be retrieved within the function callback (because of asynchronicity), by calling the array key named after the function (but without the dot and the schema name):

```
some_table : {
  form_pos : {
    "click": function(t, n){
      var sId = fn.getDataFromSiblingNode(t, n, "id");
      // call a function and use its output
      fn.callFunction("api.get_lemma", [ fn.quote(sId) ],
        function(response){
          var sLemma = response["get_lemma"]
          ...
        });
    }
  }
}
```

Call a webservice

For calling a webservice, only a few parameters are needed, a ULR and some parameters, and a callback so as to process the service's response.

```
fn.callService(sURL, aParameters, null, null, function(resp){
  // process response here
});
```

But more parameters can be given, most of which (`sMethod`, `sResponseDataType`, `fnCallback`, `fnErrorHandler`) are quite self-explanatory. The `oExtraParams` parameter might need extra explanation: it is there for additional ajax parameters that aren't part of the default function parameters, like in the following:

```
Var oExtraParams = {
  "contentType": "application/json; charset=UTF-8",
  "processData": false
};
```

Lex'it HowTo

```
fn.callService(sURL, aParameters, sMethod, sResponseDataType, fnCallback,  
oExtraParams, fnErrorHandler);
```

Advanced Lex'it programming

Lex'it internal registry

Every single piece of information about tables etc. is stored in a dedicated namespace `mt` (which stands for *multitables*). It is often needed to get info from this registry. Here are some examples.

For example, the most important object of all in Lex'it – the Datable object of some named table – can be retrieved from there:

```
var t = mt.getDataTableObjectOf(someTableName);

// go to page 1 if the results
t.page( 0 );
```

One can retrieve the names of all the tables available, so as to refresh them all:

```
var aTables = mt.getListOfLoadedTables();
for (var i=0; i< aTables.length; i++){
    fn.refreshTable(aTables[i]);
}
```

The same way, one can get a list of all (visible) columns, so as to changed their `css` properties, or whatever else:

```
var aListOfColumns = mt.getListOfVisibleColumnsOf( t );
for (var i=0; i< aListOfColumns.length; i++){
    var sColumnName = aListOfColumns[i];
    var nCell = fn.getCellInRowNode( nCurrentRow, sColumnName);

    $( nCell ).css("color", sSomeColorCode);
}
```

Check the `mt`-namespace in the JS-docs (github.com/INL/Lexit/tree/master/jsdoc) to find out what can be retrieved from the Lex'it internal registry.

Create a full new table configuration at runtime

This function is needed when one wants to call a fully configured table that didn't exist yet at start up (which is why the table was not registered nor configured yet).

```
fn.registerNewTable(sTableName, sTableDescription, sType, sTableComment,
oConfiguration, oSettings);
```

Synonym:

```
fn.declareNewTable (...);
```

Parameter	Data type	Description
sTableName	String	Name of the new table to register
sTableDescription	String	table description (visible to user in tables list)
sType	String	database table type ('base table', 'view')
sTableComment	String	table comments, which a user can edit by clicking onto the table name (in the table header) in the GUI
oConfiguration	Array	An associative array, containing the table configuration, in the way this has to be declared in oTableConfigurationList
oSettings	Array	An associative array, containing the table settings, in the way those have to be declared in oTableSettingsList

Set the active table programmatically

In Lex'it, the active table is the one that has focus. One can give another table focus, by typing:

```
fn.setActiveTable (sTableName);
```

By doing this, of course key actions assigned to this table will get active, etc.

Use libraries

Lex'it `config.js`-files can gradually grow quite large, causing such file to be more and more difficult to maintain. An easy way to solve that is (for example) moving some of the project functions to some functions library.

By default, Lex'it expects libraries to be located in the same directory as the `config.js`-files. And the libraries are expected to have the same core name as the `config.js`-file they belong to. For example, if your project is called 'myproject' and you want a function library to be attached to it, you should have two files named like this:

- `myproject.config.js`
- `myproject.library.js`

Of course, the library file must be explicitly called by the `config.js` file, so as to be effectively loaded:

```
fn.getLibrary(sPathToLibrary, fnCallback, fnErrorHandler);
```

If you follow the rules hereabove, you won't need to declare any `sPathToLibrary`, because Lex'it will know where to look for it, so use the null value instead:

```
fn.getLibrary(null, fnCallback, fnErrorHandler);
```

The `fnCallback` argument is a function the code of which must/can be executed only after the library was loaded. Finally, you can add an error handler as a third argument, but this is null by default.

Accessing session and user info

Lex'it provides with some function for accessing session and user info. That allows for different operations:

- Logging who performed some data editing

Logging who performed some data edit of a record could be implemented that way:

```
"some column": {
  "editable": true,
  "editcallback": function(t, n, value){
    var sRecordId = fn.getDataFromSiblingNode(n, "id");
    fn.insertIntoDatabase("log", {
      "record_id": sRecordId,
      "modified_by": fn.getCurrentUser(),
      "modification_time": getCurrentTimestamp()
    });
  }
}
```

This solution is of course only recommended when the developer is not allowed to edit the project database. However, when one is entitled to edit the database functions, logging should be implemented there, so as to allow logging to occur at any occasion, even when the database wasn't processed by Lex'it:

```
CREATE TRIGGER log_trigger
  AFTER INSERT OR DELETE OR UPDATE ON yourtable
  FOR EACH ROW
  EXECUTE PROCEDURE do_some_logging();
CREATE FUNCTION do_some_logging()
  RETURNS trigger
  LANGUAGE 'plpgsql'
  COST 100
  VOLATILE
AS $BODY$
BEGIN
  INSERT INTO log(record_id, modified_by, modification_time)
  SELECT NEW.id, t.username, now()
```

Lex'it HowTo

```
FROM active_user t;  -- this table is a temporary
                    -- table automatically created by Lex'it
RETURN NULL; -- result is ignored since this is an AFTER trigger
END;
$BODY$;
```

Cleaning the cache

Lex'it caches data about tables. For example, counting the exact number of rows of a large table upon any request to do so, makes no sense. Once this number is known, it can be cached, and retrieved very quickly if requested once again.

This caching concerns mostly 'table statistics' like number of rows of the whole table, or of the result set of a particular query, and 'table metadata', like primary keys, columns data types, etc. Note that the table content is *never* cached.

In some situation however, it might be needed to clean the cache, to make sure every single piece of information is reliable at that moment. To do so, call this:

```
cleanTableCache(t, fnCallBack, fnErrorHandler);
```

Setting behavior when switching between tabs containing distinct Lex'it instances

One can set a function to be executed when some Lex'it tab gains focus or loses it:

```
fn.doAtFocusGain( function() {  
    fn.refreshTable(t);  
});  
fn.doAtFocusLoss( function() {  
    ...  
});
```

Changing accessed table schema

As explained in the first sections of this document, the `.database` table sets Lex'it to access only a particular schema of a database. It has the advantage of confining Lex'it to a particular area of the database, which allows for hiding less relevant schemata etc.

But in cases in which one needs to switch to another database schema during 'runtime', some function can be called to achieve just that:

```
fn.setSchema(sNewSchema, fnCallback, fnErrorHandler);
```


Tips and tricks

Call a Lex'it projects and tables via an URL

One can open Lex'it straight in a given project (that is: skipping the menu page) by specifying the projectname in the URL:

```
http://<your_host>:8080/lexit2/?db=myproject
```

It is even possible to open a project and call a table straight away. To do so, specify the table name too:

```
http://<your_host>:8080/lexit2/?db=myproject&table=sometable
```

The next step is to get the table filtered by some values right from the start as well. Once again: just specify the filters to be applied!

```
http://<your_host>:8080/lexit2/?db=myproject&table=sometable
&columnName1=someValue1&columnName2=someValue2
```

Finally, one can also set some particular settings, like the table screen position or so. Settings can be specified the same way as anything else, but the setting name must have the 'setting.' prefix, like this:

```
http://<your_host>:8080/lexit2/?db=myproject&table=sometable
&setting.top=150px&setting.left=20px
```

N.B.: a list of all available settings can be found in section **First things first: open a table**.

Change table columns visibility and redraw table automatically

Once a table is rendered on screen, it is still possible to modify the columns' visibility programmatically, so as to switch between alternative views on the data.

Declare the list `aListOfColumns` of columns that have to be visible, and call the following function:

```
fn.changeTableColumnsVisibility(t, aListOfColumns, fnCallback, oExtraSettings);
```

This function takes care of redrawing the table properly at the very same screen position, and re-applies filters, view type, pagination, etc. If needed, some extra custom settings can be passed on with argument `oExtraSettings` (see section **The API, First things first: open a table**) and some callback can be applied to with `fnCallback`.

Synchronicity problems and solutions

When a function calls a webservice or some database function etc., we need the code that has to process the result to be waiting till the results are actually issued. Otherwise we'll end up with undefined variables etc.

In Lex'it this is supported by the implementation of callbacks. Most of the function allow one or more callbacks as a parameter. It's only when the execution of the code of the function is finished, that the callback will be run:

```
fn.updateDatabaseGivenFieldValues( t,
    {"column1": someValue1},
    {"column2": someValue2, "column3": someValue3},
    ...,
    function(){ // put some nice callback code here });
```

Sometimes one might want to execute a chain of operations, in such a way that each operation waits for the previous one to be finished before starting the current one, and so on. That can be achieved with recursion.

In the following example, we gather the id's of some rows, onto which some operations will be carried out. We then define a function to be executed on one row at the time. Since the function can process only one row at once, we want it to process the following row only when it's done with the current one.

To do that, we have the function call itself in a callback. The parameter value is increased at each call, ensuring that the next id of the list is chosen for processing. The recursion ends when the last id was reached.

```
var aIdsToProcess = new Array();
var aSelectedAtts = fn.getSelectedRowsFrom(t);
aSelectedAtts.each(function(){
    aIdsToProcess.push( fn.getNodeId(this) );
});

// process each selected row now
var functionToRepeat = function(i){
    fn.updateDatabaseGivenFieldValues( t,
        {"id_column": aIdsToProcess[i]},
        {"column1": someValue1, "column2": someValue2},
        false,
        function(){
            if ( (i+1) < aIdsToProcess.length )
            {
                functionToRepeat(i+1);
            }
            else
            {
                // finished? Refresh to see the results!
                fn.refreshTable(t);
            }
        });
};

// start the function now
// it will increment its own argument till all ids are processed
functionToRepeat(0);
```

Implement a character picker

When one needs to type in data consisting of foreign characters, with diacritics, anyhow characters not available on a current keyboard, a character picker can be the right solution. All you need is a table (let's call it 'character_picker') with one single cell, in which all needed characters are displayed, separated by spaces. Picking up a character can be done by just clicking on it.

```

"character_picker": {
    "character_picker_cell": {
        "textsize": "20pt",
        "click": function( t, n ){

            // copy chars clicked upon
            var oCell = fx.getCell(n, " character_picker_cell ");
            var oClickedUpon = fx.getWordClickedUponInCell(oCell);
            var sClickedUpon = oClickedUpon.text;

            // put the chars into an invisible textarea
            var tmpTextArea = $("<textarea></textarea>")
            .attr("id", "chosen_character").text(sClickedUpon);
            $("#temporary_stuff").append(tmpTextArea);

            // and select it!
            var copyChar = $('#chosen_character');
            copyChar.select();

            try {
                // now copy it to clipboard
                document.execCommand('copy');

                // confirm to user which chars he/she has
                chosenfn.message("Chosen character",
                "Chosen character:<BR><BR>" + sClickedUpon);

                // remove temporary textarea
                $("#chosen_character").remove();
                setTimeout(function(){

                    // remove message
                    fn.closeDialog();

                    // put focus onto the main table
                    // this will call a header function,
                    // which will make this table active
                    $("#mytable_wrapper div.top").mousedown();
                }, 1000);
            } catch (err) {

                // tell user if something went wrong
                fn.message("Selection failed, try again!");
            }
        }
    }
}

```

Scroll to a table programmatically

When a table is opened programmatically, and other tables are already open, the newly opened table might not be visible as it is automatically put at the bottom of all others. In such cases, it might be convenient to automatically scroll to it:

```
fn.scrollToTable(sTableName);
```

Help functions

String array conversion

Convert an array to a string, or back:

```
fn.arrayToString(arr);
fn.stringToArray(str);
```

Escaping chars

Escape quotes in string parameters of function or service call:

```
fn.escapeSingleQuotes(str);
escapeDoubleQuotes(str);
```

Escape regular expression characters, for example for using some string in a search query:

```
var sSearchString = fn.escapeRegexChars( someStringContainingRegexChars );
fn.callDatabase(t, {"some_column": sSearchString});
```

Http parameters

Some help function do not belong to the `fn` namespace, but are part of some `util.js` class. They are to be called without `fn` prefix or so.

Get the http parameters of Lex'it (like value of `db`, `test`, etc.):

```
Var hParams = getHttpParams(); // this is a Hashtable
Var sDb = hParams.get("db");
```

Solve z-Index problems

Put any object in front (solves many z-index problems):

```
$(obj).putInFront();
```

Objects functions

Clone an object

```
var oClone = NEW cloneObject(obj);
```

Count the number of properties of an object

```
Var iCount = countProperties(obj);
```

Regex functions

Test if a string is a regex or not

```
var bIsRegex = isRegex(str);
```

Regex version of replaceAll(string, replacement)

NB: beware: for IE compatibility, the search argument must be a string, and not a regex literal, t.i.

"^(...)\$" instead of /^(...)\$/ (well: nowadays Lex'it isn't IE compatible anymore...):

```
var sNewString = str.regexReplaceAll(regex, replacement);
```

Regex version of indexOf(regex, from) and lastIndexOf(regex, from)

```
var firstMatch = str.regexIndexOf(regex, fromStartPos);  
var lastMatch = str.regexLastIndexOf(regex, fromStartPos);
```

Regex version of inArray(value, array, start)

```
var idx = $.inArrayRegex(value, array, start);
```

Regex selectors

Examples of use in Lex'it implementation:

```
$(':regex(id,^[aeiou])');  
$('div:regex(class,[0-9])');  
$('script:regex(src,jQuery)');
```

Arrays functions

Unify any value in array

```
var aNoDoubles = getOnlyUniqueValues( arr );
```

Clone an array

```
var aClone = cloneArray(arr);
```

Array equality

```
var bEqual = arrays_equal( arr1, arr2);
```

Sort an array of arrays

```
var aaSorted = sortArrayOfArray(aaArray);
```

HTML entities

Test if a given HTML entity is a common (internationally known) entity.

```
var bTrueOrFalse = isCommonEntity(sSomeEntity);
```

Translate an entity into the character it represents

```
var sChar = translateEntityToChar(sEntity)
```

Translate a character into the corresponding entity

```
var sEntity = translateCharToEntity(sChar);
```

Numbers

Generate series (JavaScript version of Psql function)

NB: de series generated contains 0-prefixes (like: 002, 003, ...) so as to match the length of the biggest member of the series (iEndValue).

```
var aStr = generateSeries(iStartValue, iEndValue, bAscending);
```

Get a random unique number

Based on the current date, this number is surely unique

```
var iUniqueNumber = getUniqueNumber();
```

String functions

The good old BASIC or JAVA functions

```
var sLeftPart = left(str, n);  
var sRightPart = right(str, n);  
var bTrueOfFalse = $.startsWith(str, search);  
var bTrueOfFalse = $.endsWith(str, search);
```

String replacement

Normal and regex version

```
var sNewStr = str.replaceAll(regex, replacement)  
var sNewStr = str.regexReplaceAll(regex, replacement);
```

Remove HTML tags from a string

```
var sCleanStr = removeTags(str);
```

Remove non alphabetical chars from string

```
var sCleanStr = keepOnlyLettersAndDigits(str);
```

If a string a string?

```
var bTrueOfFalse = $.isString(str);
```

If a string truly empty?

```
var bTrueOfFalse = $.emptyString(str);
```

Colors

Is a color dark or light?

```
// parameter might be RGB or HEX color code  
var lightOrDark = lightOrDark(color);
```

Convert a string to a color

NB: sometimes convenient for random color generation

```
// output is HEX color code
var sColor = stringToColour(str);
```

Generate some color code, but make sure it's not too light or so

```
// generate random color for group of variants
sColor = stringToColour(sLem);
while( lightOrDark(sColor) == 'light'){
    sColor = ColorLuminance(sColor, -0.1)
}
```

Text selection

Allow or prevent screen text selection

```
$('html, body').enableSelection();
$('html, body').disableSelection();
```

Clear screen text selection

```
clearSelection();
```

DOM elements functions

Test if some element is visible in the current viewport

```
$(el).elementExists();
```

Does an element exist?

```
$(el).isOnScreen();
```

Events

Pre-binding

Pre-bind function, t.i. bind a handler to some event, to be executed before all other handlers of the same event.

```
$('#button').preBind('click', function() {
    console.log('hello');
});
```


PSQL functions in Lex'it

Call a PSQL-function and read the result

```
fn.callFunction("api.do_something", [arg1, arg2], function(resp){ ... });
```

If the PSQL function `api.do_something` is called as here above, the way results must be read depends on the output type of the function.

If the PSQL function returns a simplex result like an single integer or string (...RETURNS text AS...), one should extract that out of the response by addressing the name of the function:

```
var ourResult = resp["do_something"];
```

As you probably already noticed, the schema name (`api.`) mustn't be used, but only the basic function name (`do_something`).

But if the function returns a complex result like a table record (...RETURNS TABLE(id integer, some_string text) AS...), one should extract that out of the response by addressing the separate field names:

```
var ourId = resp["id"];  
var ourString = resp["some_string"];
```

Concordance table for the fn and fx namespaces

fn functions	fx function
fn.addCustomButton(sSomeTableName, ...)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.addDrawCallback(sSomeTablename, ...)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.addFilters(sSomeTable, ...)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.alignTables(sSomeTablename1, ...)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.arrayToString(str)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.askToChoose(sTitle, ...)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.callDatabase(sSomeTablename, ...)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.callDatabaseInNewTab(sSomeTablename, ...)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.callFunction(sFunctionName, ...)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.callRecord(nRow, ...)	fx.callRecord(oRow, ...)
fn.callService(sUrl, ...)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.changeTableColumnsVisibility(sTable, ...)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.cleanTableCache(sSomeTablename, ...)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.clearAllFilters(sSomeTable)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.clickOnButton(sTableName, ...)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.closeDialog()	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.closeTable(sSomeTablename, ...)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.confirm(sTitle, ...)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.declareNewTable(...)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.doAtFocusGain(fnFunction)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.duplicateRecord(sSomeTablename, ...)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.editFunctionIsActiveNow()	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.escapeDoubleQuotes(str)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.escapeRegexChars(str)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.escapeSingleQuotes(str)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.forceExactCount()	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.getActiveRowNode(someTable)	fx.getActiveRow(t)
fn.getAllRowNodes(sSomeTablename)	fx.getAllRows(t)
fn.getAllRowNodesWhere(sSomeTablename, ...)	fx.getAllRowsWhere(t, ...)
fn.getCellInRowNode(nRow, ...)	fx.getCell(mixed, ...)
<i>Not needed</i>	fx.getCellNode(oRow, ...)
fn.getCellNodeType(nMixed, ...)	fx.getCellType(oMixed, ...)
fn.getCheckboxValue(nCell)	fx.getCheckboxValue(oCell)
fn.getColumnNumberOf(sSomeTable, ...)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.getCurrentDisplayLength(sSomeTablename)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.getCurrentDisplayStart(sSomeTablename)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.getCurrentProject()	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.getCurrentSessionId()	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.getCurrentTabId()	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.getCurrentTimestamp(sFormatopt)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.getCurrentUser()	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.getCustomButtonCss(sTableName, ...)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.getDataFromCellNode(nCell)	fx.getDataFromCell(oCell)
fn.getDataFromCellInRowNode(nRow, ...)	fx.getDataFromCellInRow(oRow, ...)
fn.getDataFromColumn(sSomeTable, ...)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.getDataFromRowNode(nRow)	fx.getDataFromRow(oRow)

fn.getDataFromSiblingNode(nCell, ...)	fx.getDataFromSiblingCell(oCell, ...)
fn.getFilters(sSomeTable)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.getFirstRowNodeFrom(someTable)	fx.getFirstRowFrom(oSomeTable)
fn.getFirstSelectedRowNodeFrom(someTable)	fx.getFirstSelectedRowFrom(oSomeTable)
fn.getFunctionOutput()	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.getGlobalFilter(sSomeTable)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.getHighlight(sString, ...)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.getIdFromDatabase(sSomeTablename, ...)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.getIndexofButtonNamed(sTableName, ...)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.getIndexofFirstSelectedRowNodeFrom(sTable)	fx.getIndexofFirstSelectedRowFrom(oSomeTable)
fn.getLibrary(sPathopt, ...)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.getNameOfButtonAtIndex(sTableName, ...)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.getNameOfColumnForThisNode(nCell)	fx.getNameOfColumnForThisCell(oCell)
fn.getNameOfColumnForThisVisibleIndex(sTable, .)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.getNewPositionOfElementAt(iOriginalIndex)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.getNextRowNode(nRow)	<i>Not needed</i>
<i>Not needed</i>	fx.getNode(oMixed)
fn.getNumberOfSelectedRowNodes(someTable)	fx.getNumberOfSelectedRows(someTable)
fn.getNumberOfVisibleRows(someTable)	fx.getNumberOfVisibleRows(someTable)
fn.getPreviousRowNode(nRow)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.getPromptBoxInput(sFieldName)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.getPromptBoxOrder()	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.getRecord(sSomeTablename, ...)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.getRecordGivenFieldValues(sTablename, ...)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.getRecords(sSomeTablename, ...)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.getRowNode(nMixed)	fx.getRow(nRow)
<i>Not needed</i>	fx.getRowFromCell(oCell)
fn.getRowNodeId(nMixed)	fx.getRowId(oRow)
fn.getRowNodeIndex(nRow)	fx.getRowIndex(oRow)
fn.getRowNodeNumberOnScreen(nRow)	fx.getRowNumberOnScreen(oRow)
fn.getRowNodeWhere(sSomeTablename, ...)	fx.getRowWhere(sSomeTable, ...)
fn.getRowNodeWhereIds(sSomeTable, ...)	fx.getRowWhereIds(sSomeTable, ...)
fn.getSelectedRowNodesFrom(someTable)	fx.getSelectedRowsFrom(oSomeTable)
fn.getSelectedTextInNode(nMixed, ...)	fx.getSelectedTextInCell(oCell, ...)
fn.getSortingColumns(sSomeTablename)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.getSortingDirection(sSomeTablename)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.getSortingDirectionOf(sSomeTablename, ...)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.getSortingDirections(sSomeTablename)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.getTableExtraSettings(sSomeTablename)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.getTableName(mixed)	fx.getTableName(oMixed)
fn.getTablePosition(sSomeTablename)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.getTypeOfFilterBox(sSomeTablename, ...)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.getValueOfFilterBox(sSomeTable, ...)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.getViewType(sSomeTablename)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.getVisibleColumnNumberOf(sSomeTable, ...)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.getWordClickedUponInNode(nMixed,)	fx.getWordClickedUponInCell(oCell, ...)
fn.goToNextPage(sSomeTable)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.goToPreviousPage(sSomeTable)	<i>Not needed</i>

fn.goToTheRightPage(sSomeTable, ...)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.hideTable(sSomeTablename)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.insertIntoDatabase(sSomeTablename, ...)	<i>Not needed</i>
<i>Not needed</i>	fx.isApiInstance(obj)
fn.isCellNode(nMixed)	fx.isCell(oMixed)
fn.isEditableNode(nCell)	fx.isEditableCell(oCell)
fn.isLastNodeOf(nRow, ...)	fx.isLastRowOf(oRow, ...)
fn.isRowNode(nMixed)	fx.isRow(oMixed)
fn.message(sTitle, ...)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.pileupTables(sSomeTablename1 ...)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.preventAutomaticStartup()	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.processPromptBoxOrder(aPromptBoxOrder, ...)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.prompt(sTitle, ...)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.promptReorder(sTitle, ...)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.promptSelect(sTitle, ...)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.putDataIntoCellNode(nRow, ...)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.putDataIntoFilterBox(sSomeTable, ...)	<i>Not needed</i>
<i>Not needed</i>	fx.putDataIntoCell(oRow, ...)
fn.quote(str)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.refreshTable(sSomeTablename)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.registerNewTable(sTableName, ...)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.removeFromDatabaseGivenANode(nRow, ...)	fx.removeFromDatabaseGivenARow(oRow, ...)
fn.removeFromDatabaseGivenFieldValues(sTable, ...)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.removeHighlight(sString)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.removeProcessingMsg(sSomeTablename)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.resetAllFilters(sSomeTable, ...)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.resetTable(sSomeTablename, ...)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.restoreTableState(sSomeTablename)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.rowsSelectionIsAllowed(sSomeTablename)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.saveTableState(sSomeTablename)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.scrollToTable(sSomeTablename)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.selectAllRowNodes(sSomeTable)	fx.selectAllRows(sSomeTable)
fn.selectRowNode(sSomeTable, ...)	fx.selectRow(sSomeTable, ...)
fn.setActiveTable(sSomeTablename)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.setAutoComplete(sSomeTablename, ...)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.setBackgroundColor(sColor)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.setCurrentUser(sName, ...)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.setCustomButtonCss(sTableName, ...)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.setCustomButtonName(sTableName, ...)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.setFilters(sSomeTable, ...)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.setGlobalFilter(sSomeTable, ...)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.setProjectTitle(sProjectName, ...)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.setSchema(sNewSchema, ...)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.setSorting(sSomeTablename, ...)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.showProcessingMsg(sSomeTablename)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.showTable(sSomeTablename)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.stringToArray(str)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.tableExists(sSomeTablename)	<i>Not needed</i>

Lex'it HowTo

fn.tableIsEmpty(sSomeTablename)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.tableIsHidden(sSomeTablename)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.toggleCheckbox(nRow, ...)	fx.toggleCheckbox(oRow, ...)
fn.triggerKeyStrikeOnElement(iKeyCode, ...)	<i>Not needed</i>
fn.uncheckCheckboxes(nMixed, ...)	fx.uncheckCheckboxes(oRow, ...)
fn.unselectAllRowNodes(sSomeTable)	fx.unselectAllRows(sSomeTable)
fn.unselectRowNode(sSomeTable, ...)	fx.unselectRow(sSomeTable, ...)
fn.updateDatabaseGivenANode(nMixed, ...)	fx.updateDatabaseGivenACellOrRow(oMixed, ...)
fn.updateDatabaseGivenFieldValues(sTable, ...)	<i>Not needed</i>